

Carrot Soup

This easy carrot soup recipe is a great way to use up a bag of carrots that were forgotten in your produce drawer. The carrots cook together with aromatics like onions, garlic and fresh herbs before being pureed into a silky smooth soup that's delicious for dinner or packed up for lunch.

By **Carolyn Malcoun** | Updated on September 28, 2025

✓ Reviewed by Dietitian **Sarah Pflugrad, Ph.D., RDN, CSCS**

Active Time: 40 mins

Additional Time: 10 mins

Total Time: 50 mins

Servings: 8

Yield: 8 servings, about 1 cup each

Nutrition Profile:

Nut-Free Soy-Free Egg-Free Gluten-Free

Ingredients

1 tablespoon butter

1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil

1 medium onion, chopped

1 stalk celery, chopped

2 cloves garlic, chopped

1 teaspoon chopped fresh thyme or parsley

5 cups chopped carrots

2 cups water

4 cups reduced-sodium chicken broth, "no-chicken" broth (see Note) or vegetable broth

½ cup half-and-half (optional)

½ teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon freshly ground pepper to taste

Directions

Step 1

Heat 1 tablespoon butter and 1 tablespoon oil in a Dutch oven over medium heat until the butter melts. Add onion and celery; cook, stirring occasionally, until softened, 4 to 6 minutes. Add garlic and 1 teaspoon thyme (or parsley); cook, stirring, until fragrant, about 10 seconds. Stir in carrots. Add 2 cups water and 4

cups broth; bring to a lively simmer over high heat. Reduce heat to maintain a lively simmer and cook until very tender, about 25 minutes.

Step 2

Puree the soup in batches in a blender until smooth. (Use caution when pureeing hot liquids.) Stir in ½ cup half-and-half (if using), ½ teaspoon salt and ¼ teaspoon pepper.

Equipment

Dutch oven, blender

Frequently Asked Questions

Is Carrot Soup vegetarian?

It can be! We like the savory flavor of chicken broth, but if you want a vegetarian soup, chicken-flavored broth (a vegetarian broth despite its name) is preferable to vegetable broth for its hearty, rich flavor and light golden color. Vegetable broth will work too, but it may darken the color. Sometimes called "no-chicken" broth, it can be found with the soups in the natural foods section of most supermarkets.

How do I make Carrot Soup extra creamy?

The easiest way to make your carrot soup creamy is to simply add cream after it's blended. (We prefer half-and-half to cut back on saturated fat.) If you want to skip the cream entirely, using a high-powered stand blender can give you light and creamy results. A regular stand blender works well too, but you may have to blend it for longer. When using any stand blender, be sure to remove the centerpiece from the lid and hold a clean towel over the hole to prevent burns.

How should I store Carrot Soup?

Cover and refrigerate the soup for up to 4 days or freeze it in a freezer-safe container for up to 3 months.

What can I serve with Carrot Soup?

This carrot soup is delicious paired with grilled cheese sandwiches. Try it with Spinach-&-Artichoke-Dip Grilled Cheese, French Onion Grilled Cheese, Collards & Portobello Grilled Cheese or Spanakopita Grilled Cheese Sandwiches and a side salad to complete the meal.

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size about 2 cups** 176 calories; total fat 8g; saturated fat 3g; cholesterol 8mg; sodium 486mg; total carbohydrate 22g; dietary fiber 5g; total sugars 9g; protein 7g; vitamin c 13mg; calcium 81mg; iron 1mg; potassium 795mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S., Hilary Meyer, Jan Valdez, *and* Linda Frahm

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